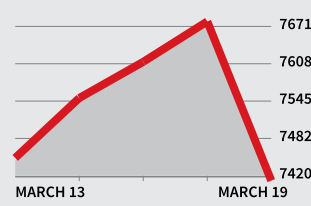


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 74207.24 (-2496.89)

IN FOCUS



	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23002.15	-775.65
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.37	-0.69
US Dollar (in ₹)	---	---
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147297.00	-6962
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	229873.00	-20034

INHERENT STRENGTH

PMEAC chief S Mahendra Dev is optimistic about India's resilience as crude oil prices rise above \$114/bbl **P7**



LOSING SHEEN

Gold and silver prices crashed in India following the bearish sentiment in the global market **P8**

Sensex, Nifty crash 3.26% in biggest fall since June 2024

BIG SHOCK. Crude above \$110 & hawkish US Fed hurt sentiment; HDFC Bank leads fall

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

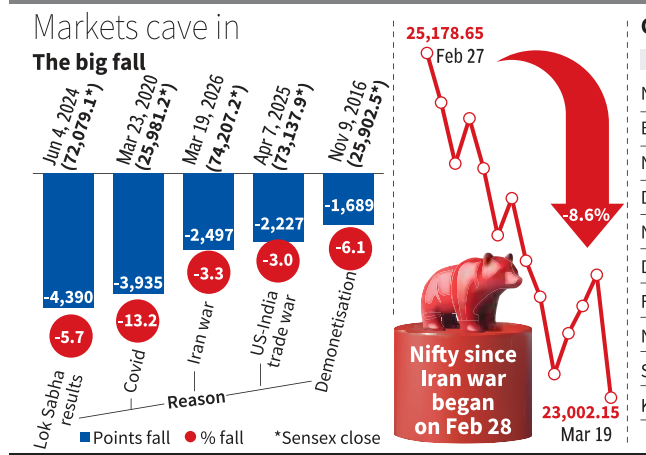
In their worst single-day fall since June 2024, the BSE Sensex and the Nifty50 crashed 3.3 per cent on Thursday, weighed down by a sharp sell-off in HDFC Bank, a spike in crude prices and the hawkish stance of the US Federal Reserve.

The Sensex fell nearly 2,500 points and the Nifty tumbled over 775 points, with Shriram Finance, Eternal and HDFC Bank leading the losses.

INDIA VIX SURGES

The volatility indicator, India VIX, surged over 21 per cent to 22.80. The sell-off, triggered by the escalating West Asia conflict that sent Brent crude surging past \$110 per barrel, wiped out the gains of the past three sessions in a single day.

The US Federal Reserve's decision to hold benchmark rates steady at 3.50-3.75 per cent, while signalling a higher inflation outlook due to rising energy prices, compounded the negative senti-



Global stocks

	Close	% fall
Nifty 50	23,002.15	-3.26
BSE Sensex	74,207.24	-3.26
Nifty Bank	53,451.00	-3.39
Dow Jones*	45,991.40	-0.51
Nasdaq*	22,077.10	-0.34
DAX*	22,920.15	-2.46
FTSE 100*	10,061.50	-2.39
Nikkei 225	53,372.53	-3.38
Shanghai	4,006.55	-1.39
KOSPI	5,763.22	-2.73

the range of 1-4 per cent.

BULLION TUMBLES

Contrary to expectations, safe-haven assets offered no refuge. Gold fell over 3.4 per cent on the Comex, breaching \$4,700/oz, while silver dropped nearly 6 per cent as the Fed's hawkish posture strengthened the dollar.

Analysts said a clear de-escalation in West Asia is the only near-term catalyst that can arrest the downtrend, failing which the index remains biased towards further weakness.

'Iranian attack wipes out 17% of Qatar's LNG capacity for up to five years'

Reuters

Dubai / Doha

Iranian attacks have knocked out 17 per cent of Qatar's LNG export capacity, causing an estimated \$20 billion in lost annual revenue and threatening supplies to Europe and Asia, said QatarEnergy's CEO.

Saad Al-Kaabi said two of Qatar's 14 LNG trains and one of its two gas-to-liquids (GTL) facilities were damaged in the strikes. The repairs will sideline 12.8 million tonnes per year of LNG for three to five years, he said. "I never in my wildest dreams would have thought that Qatar and the region would be in such an attack, especially from a brotherly Muslim country," said Kaabi.

Hours earlier, Iran aimed a series of attacks at Gulf oil and gas facilities after Israeli attacks on its own gas infrastructure. State-owned QatarEnergy will have to declare *force majeure* on long-term contracts for up to five years for LNG supplies bound for Italy, Belgium, South Korea and China due to the two damaged trains, said Kaabi.

Also see p3

HDFC Bank downplays talk of power struggle post Chakraborty's sudden exit

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The sudden exit of Atanu Chakraborty as part-time Chairman and Independent Director of HDFC Bank has stirred a hornet's nest, with its stock taking a beating amid talk of a power struggle, which the bank's board has strongly refuted.

The RBI backed the bank, stating that there were no material concerns on record about its conduct or governance.

'AGAINST MY VALUES'

Chakraborty, who was part-time Chairman since May 2021, put in his papers citing "certain happenings and practices within the bank, that I have observed over last two years, are not in congruence with my personal values and ethics".

In his resignation letter, he also observed that the benefits of the 2023 merger (of HDFC with HDFC Bank) are yet to fully fructify.

Banking sector experts said the bank board may approach M Rajeshwar Rao, former Deputy Governor of RBI, to replace Chakraborty. The role of Kaizad Bharucha, Deputy Managing Director, is also set to expand, according to Keki Mistry, who said



Keki Mistry, interim part-time Chairman of HDFC Bank

that he would be getting more responsibilities. Mistry has been appointed interim part-time Chairman of the bank from March 19 for three months.

HDFC Bank's stock hit a 52-week low of ₹772 on Thursday on the BSE. It closed at ₹779.70 apiece, down 5.13 per cent (or ₹43.25).

Addressing analysts, Mistry emphasised that there is no "power struggle" in HDFC Bank, and some relationship issues will always be there between individuals in any organisation.

Chakraborty's exit comes amid reports that he insisted on a review of the bank chief's tenure before recommending a further extension of his tenure, and the alleged strain in relationship between some of the CXOs.

Sashidhar Jagdishan has been helming the bank as MD and CEO since October

27, 2020. His second three-year term ends in October 2026.

Mistry said: "And believe me... at the age of 71, I would not take on this responsibility [as Interim Chairman] for three months if the systems, processes and governance practices in the bank do not align with my principles and my level of integrity... RBI gave their approval for making me Interim Chairman for a period of three months just to stabilise things and then move on."

NO MATERIAL ISSUES

To a question on the possibility of a power struggle, Mistry said: "Differences on minor issues do come up from time to time, but there is nothing material whatsoever... There will always be some relationship issues between individuals. Those kind of things happen. There is no power struggle in the bank, as you put it."

Renu Sud Karnad, Non-Executive (non-independent) Director, said: "In fact, we repeatedly asked him [Chakraborty] to tell us why... what had triggered this [resignation], and if there was anything we have to do to set it right. But he said there was nothing. And that was a bit baffling."

Also see p2

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Exit rattles mutual fund investors, concerns loom

Suresh P Iyengar
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Feedstock facts

India should diversify sourcing of fertilizer feedstock

Localised fertilizer shortages have been a recurring feature of India’s agricultural seasons in recent years. This year, the Government took proactive steps by contracting for imports in February, resulting in stocks of 62 lakh tonnes of urea, 25 lakh tonnes of Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP) and 56 lakh tonnes of complex fertilizers being available by mid-March. Urea inventories are currently 20 per cent higher than in the same period last year, DAP stocks are double last year’s levels and complex fertilizers 80 per cent higher.



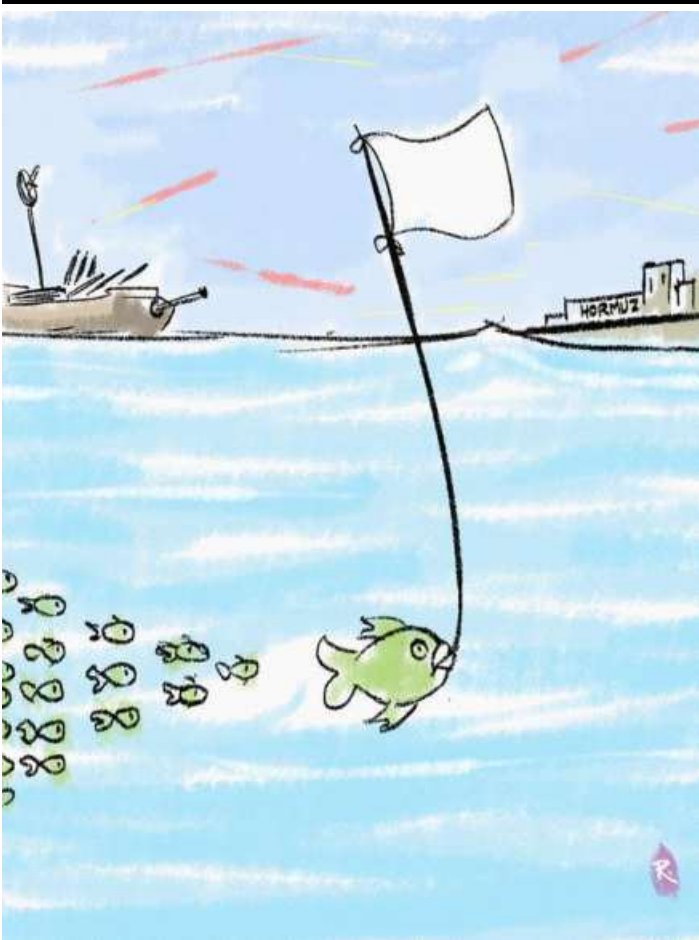
While this will help farmers tide over the initial months of kharif sowing, the Iran conflict can lead to shortages re-emerging later. There appear to be no quick fixes here. Even if India manages to secure safe passage for India-bound ships via the Strait of Hormuz, severely disrupted global supply chains for LNG (Liquified Natural Gas), sulphur, phosphoric acid and ammonia could take time to normalise. This can have a lasting impact on prices of fertilizers, forcing the Centre to incur a larger subsidy bill than budgeted.

The past decade has seen India make concerted efforts to achieve self-sufficiency in fertilizers. Under the New Investment Policy initiated in 2013, six new urea units were commissioned through designated PSUs, adding 7.6 million tonnes per annum of additional capacity by 2025. Urea output thus hit 30.7 million tonnes by FY25 with import dependence reduced to 15 per cent. However, LNG supplies to produce ammonia are the industry’s Achilles Heel, with 50-60 per cent of gas needs still met through imports. The Iran conflict is likely to lead to idling of recently built urea capacity, despite the Centre’s diktat to oil companies to meet 70 per cent of the fertilizer industry’s gas needs. On DAP, the situation is more fraught. With 50-60 per cent import dependence, hardly any new capacity has come up in the last decade due to unviable pricing. Indian fertilizer majors had inked an agreement with Saudi Arabia’s Maaden in July 2025 for 3.1 million tonnes of annual DAP supply over a five-year period, but it is not clear if supplies can arrive now.

As India’s fertilizer shortages stem from a lack of natural resources, there aren’t many long-term solutions. Attempts can be made to de-risk the LNG supply chain through geographical diversification. While India has effectively diversified its crude oil imports across 40 countries, its LNG imports rely heavily on West Asia with Qatar making up 50 per cent of imports by volume, the UAE contributing 15 per cent and Oman about 5 per cent. Diversifying supply origins to Australia, Russia and African nations, apart from the US, could help. Building strategic reserves for LNG, as is being done for crude oil will surely help. With coal in plentiful supply, the coal gasification route for urea production can also be explored. More than all this though, realistic pricing of fertilizers aligned to production costs are very much the need of day, as only this can spur balanced use of nutrients.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



Design will drive competitiveness

VALUE BOOSTER. Design will be key as buyers become increasingly attentive to lifecycle cost, safety and sustainability



VIPIN SONDHI
MUSHARRAF AAMIR

India’s next phase of industrial growth will be determined not only by how much it produces, but by the value built into what it produces. Design, in that sense, is not decoration; it is how value is created. Our digital payments transformation offers a useful illustration. UPI scaled not merely because the technology worked, but because it was designed for easy use; interoperable systems and intuitive interfaces that made digital payments part of everyday life. A complex transaction became effortless and trustworthy. That is design operating as institutional capability.

If we can embed design into public digital infrastructure at that scale, the question is why design remains under-leveraged in manufacturing, exports, MSME upgrading and citizen-facing services; the arenas that will shape competitiveness in the coming decade.

FROM SCALE TO VALUE

Manufacturing’s share in India’s gross value added remains at roughly 15 per cent of GDP. Merchandise exports are above \$400 billion annually. On a base of that scale, even a modest improvement in export realisation driven by better product definition and reliability translates into billions of dollars in additional value without shipping a single extra container.

The coming decade is unlikely to reward scale alone. Buyers are increasingly attentive to lifecycle cost, safety and sustainability. Market access is shaped as much by regulatory and environmental filters as by price. Global supply chains are also being reconfigured along geopolitical lines, making differentiation and trusted capability more valuable than simple cost arbitrage. In such an environment, the ability to define and design products becomes not just an economic advantage but a strategic capability.

Competing primarily on price compresses margins and risks entrenching firms in low-differentiation segments. As India looks towards 2047, the central industrial question is no longer scale alone but sustainable value capture. The Prime Minister has emphasised that ambition with the call: “Design in India, Design for the World.” If Make in India helped build scale and capability, the next phase must build differentiation, sustainability and brand pull.

In that context, as Vipin Sondhi and Rajendra Srivastava argued in these



VITAL ROLE. Design spans product architecture, ergonomics, manufacturability, serviceability and lifecycle efficiency GETTY IMAGES

columns earlier, the Smile Curve remains instructive. Higher value accrues upstream in research and design, and downstream in branding and service. Manufacturing, while essential, operates under sustained price pressure. The opportunity is not to withdraw from manufacturing but to upgrade it, so firms compete because products are better defined, easier to use and more sustainable.

“Design in India” therefore becomes a pathway from cost-led competition to value-led differentiation.

THE VALUE GAP

Consider a typical auto component exporter operating in a competitive global market. Without early-stage design integration — in materials, architecture or lifecycle optimisation — the firm may compete effectively on cost yet struggle to differentiate. Margins remain thin, orders volatile and dependence on a narrow buyer base persists.

When design is embedded early improving durability, reducing weight or simplifying serviceability, export realisations improve and customer stickiness deepens. The difference is structural, not cosmetic. Participation without product definition limits value capture.

Capital markets provide a useful signal. Firms that control product architecture, intellectual property and customer interface consistently command valuation multiples far above those that manufacture at scale. The contrast between global brands such as

Targeted design interventions can improve productivity, reduce unit costs and enhance reliability, reinforcing that design operates not only at the brand level, but on the shop floor

Nike and the contract manufacturers that produce its footwear, illustrates how design ownership and brand control shape value capture.

Domestic experience points in the same direction. Case studies under the MSME-NID Design Clinic Scheme suggest that targeted design interventions can improve productivity, reduce unit costs and enhance reliability, reinforcing that design operates not only at the brand level, but on the shop floor.

Design is still too often equated with styling. In practice, it is the discipline through which intent translates into performance. It spans product architecture, ergonomics, manufacturability, serviceability and lifecycle efficiency.

It surfaces trade-offs between cost and durability, speed and safety, convenience and compliance and resolves them coherently. When embedded early, design reduces downstream friction: fewer defects, fewer returns, shorter learning curves and stronger trust. When appended late, it becomes surface treatment and the penalties appear in weak differentiation and avoidable lifecycle costs.

Viewed through this lens, a National Design Policy would be less about creative expression and more about productivity, resilience and competitiveness.

THE CONTEXT HAS CHANGED

The 2007 National Design Policy recognised design as a driver of competitiveness, strengthened institutional capacity and built important scaffolding. It was a necessary beginning. The context of 2026, however, is materially different. Sustainability expectations have sharpened. Digital interfaces define both citizen and customer experience. Global supply chains demand differentiated and compliant products. India’s 2047 ambition of becoming a developed economy implies not merely higher output, but higher value intensity.

Why India lags in gas storage capacity

The need for expensive storage was not felt before the current Gulf crisis as imported gas was cheap and easily available

bl.explainer

Richa Mishra

Amid escalating West Asia tensions, global energy prices are surging and supply for big consumers like India is becoming a challenge. At this juncture, reserves, both commercial and strategic, of crude oil, LNG, LPG, etc., gain importance. components

Why is fossil fuel storage capacity, strategic or commercial, important?

The fossil fuel storage capacity is generally categorised into two — government-led or strategic reserves and refiners-led or commercial reserves. It is seen as a critical component for energy management. It protects against the inherent volatility of the energy market.

These reserves work as a buffer against supply shocks caused by geopolitical conflicts, natural disasters, and major technical failures. Having a stockpile ensures operational continuity. Importantly, it acts as a deterrent to adversaries who could use oil and gas as a political weapon or bargaining chip. The storage provides a mechanism to mitigate the financial

risks associated with oil and gas price volatility.

What is the status of LPG storage capacity?

As of March 18, India’s LPG storage capacity is considered critically limited, covering less than two days of national consumption, according to reports. While the country is a global leader in cooking gas distribution, its infrastructure is primarily designed for operational flow rather than long-term strategic stockpiling.

India currently relies on two major underground LPG storage caverns to manage its energy security, besides capacities held by the refiners themselves. The Visakhapatnam facility is operated by South Asia LPG Company (SALPG) (a JV between HPCL and TotalEnergies). This facility has a capacity of 60,000 tonnes. The Mangaluru facility, recently completed by HPCL, is India’s largest cavern with a capacity of 80,000 tonnes. Together, these facilities hold approximately 1.4 lakh tonnes, which meets less than two days of the nation’s average daily demand of about 90,000 tonnes.

Why has India not created large-scale strategic LPG storage?



PRIORITY. Rapid access of gas over long-term securityISTOCK

This is primarily because its infrastructure was built for operational flow (moving gas quickly from ports to homes) rather than long-term stockpiling.

While India maintains extensive SPRs for crude oil, several technical, geological, and economic factors have hindered similar reserves for LPG. Until recent geopolitical tensions in the Strait of Hormuz, LPG was cheaply and abundantly available in the global market, reducing the perceived economic need for expensive storage insurance.

What is the status on creating

strategic gas reserves?

New Delhi is actively transitioning from a purely operational storage model to a strategic one for natural gas. No operational Strategic Gas Reserve currently exists in the same way as the SPRs for crude oil.

Subsequent to the recent supply shocks and the West Asia crisis, the government has accelerated plans for a dedicated gas buffer.

According to reports, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas has reportedly drafted a proposal and completed stakeholder consultations to create a dedicated entity for strategic gas reserves.

A proposal is under review to mandate an additional 10 per cent storage requirement for LNG/LPG terminals to strengthen defences against global supply shocks. Meanwhile, Engineers India Ltd (EIL) is conducting feasibility reports for six new reserve locations, including salt caverns in Bikaner (Rajasthan) which are considered ideal for gas storage.

India’s lag in strategic LPG and natural gas storage is the result of a policy that prioritised rapid access over long-term security, combined with significant technical and geological hurdles.

The issue is no longer recognising design, but institutionalising it at scale.

THE STRUCTURAL GAPS

Three structural constraints merit attention.

First, diffusion: design capability remains concentrated, with much of the MSME base continuing to treat design as packaging rather than product architecture.

Second, demand signalling: procurement norms, standards and export incentives do not yet consistently reward lifecycle performance and usability, limiting incentives for design investment.

Third, integration: design cuts across manufacturing, education, sustainability and standards. Without an empowered integrator, initiatives fragment rather than compound.

Left unaddressed, these constraints risk a predictable outcome: manufacturing scale expands, but value capture remains constrained.

WHAT POLICY COULD PRIORITISE

A contemporary National Design Policy may be most effective if it concentrates on three strategic levers. First, strengthen demand signals by embedding lifecycle performance, user outcomes and sustainability criteria into procurement and standards frameworks. Second, democratise access by enabling MSMEs and clusters to integrate design early through shared prototyping infrastructure and industry-linked capability programmes. Third, institutionalise integration by building design-engineering collaboration within manufacturing clusters and ecosystems rather than at their margins.

Progress should be measured through outcomes; improved certification pass rates, reduced defects, shorter product development cycles and rising export unit values in targeted categories.

THE NEXT PHASE

India’s next decade will be judged not only by manufacturing volumes but by the value density of what it produces and exports. If scale expands without upgrading product architecture, participation in global supply chains may deepen without commensurate value capture. If design becomes embedded as capability, India strengthens not just output, but economic resilience and brand credibility. The 2007 policy built the foundation. A renewed National Design Policy represents the logical progression by aligning industrial ambition with thoughtful product definition.

Scale builds volume. Design determines value.

Sondhi is former MD and CEO of Ashok Leyland and JCB India, and Aamir is a policy analyst at QCI. Views are personal

✉ LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Market movement

This refers to ‘Course correction’ (March 19). Discussions around benchmarks such as the Nifty 50 often tend to attribute market movements primarily to changes in P/E multiples. Investors rarely rely on a single metric; instead, they weigh growth prospects, macroeconomic trends, and demand-supply dynamics alongside valuations. A “one-size-fits-all” framework that uses P/E multiples as the primary yardstick across markets and sectors

may fail to capture these nuances, leading to incomplete interpretations of index and stock price movements.
Srinivasan Velamur
Chennai

Select wisely

This refers to ‘The elite degree problem’ (March 19). The preference for faculty with a PhD from select institutions like IITs and IIMs by private universities raises two issues. On the twin prerequisites for

effective teaching — knowledge and its communication with the students in a way they can understand — such faculty ensures the former while the lack of the latter limits the transmission of knowledge resulting in the underutilisation of the talent of the faculty. There are exceptions, no doubt, but with 66 per cent of the colleges being in the private sector, the learning gap may not be bridged despite the recruitment of such faculty. Also, experience tells that given the

faith in the calibre of such faculty the selection process may be influenced by the ‘halo effect’ and wrong judgments may be made.
YG Chouksey
Pune

Growth and happiness

This refers to ‘For GDP growth that spurs happiness’ (March 19). Welfare is a state of mind. India has a rich cultural heritage. This means that our philosophy is so strong that we can be happy with even less goods

and services or GDP. That said, I fully agree with the writer’s observation that the safety, the cleanliness, the relocation and the relaxation industries can increase the GDP as well as the welfare of the people. In other words, a little investment in the aforesaid industries can have a multiplier effect on the employment, income, demand and output in the economy, and also intangible happiness or welfare.
S Ramakrishnasayee
Chennai

QUICKLY.

Singer India lists on NSE, slumps 7.9% at ₹70.43



Chennai: Singer India on Thursday announced the listing of its equity shares on the National Stock Exchange. Shares of the company are already listed on BSE. The additional listing strengthens its presence in the capital markets, enhances investor access and reinforces its commitment to strong governance, transparency and long-term value creation, it said in a statement. While the stock closed on the BSE at 70.53, down 7.77 per cent, on the NSE, it slumped 7.9 per cent at ₹70.43. OUR BUREAU

Rajputana Stainless falls 7.5% on Day 1 of listing

New Delhi: Shares of Rajputana Stainless, a manufacturer of long and flat stainless steel products, ended over 7 per cent lower on Thursday, its first day of trading against the issue price of ₹112. The stock ended at ₹112.90, down 7.45 per cent on the BSE. Earlier in the day, it started trading at ₹123.95, up 1.59 per cent from the issue price, but failed to hold on to the gains. At the NSE, the stock was listed on a par with the issue price of ₹122. It later ended at ₹113.03, down 7.35 per cent. The company's market valuation stood at ₹943.48 crore. The initial public offer of Rajputana Stainless was subscribed 1.12 times. The IPO ran from March 9-11. The IPO had a fresh issue of up to 1,46,50,000 equity shares and an offer for sale of up to 62,50,000 shares. Price range for the offer was fixed at ₹116-122 per share. PTI

Market correction opens tremendous opportunity for FPIs: SEBI Member

ON THE CHART. Regulator eyes smoother access for Russian investors; pitches India listings, Gift City route

Our Bureau Mumbai

Recent corrections in Indian equities amid geopolitical tensions have made valuations “quite attractive,” creating a “tremendous opportunity” for foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) to increase allocations, said Kamlesh Chandra Varshney, Whole-Time Member, Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI). “There is a tremendous opportunity to invest in Indian equity markets with the kind of correction which has taken place in the last few months, particularly after the war broke out,” Varshney said at a Russia-India forum on capital market integration at the NSE.

His comments come even as FPIs have remained net sellers so far in FY26, with over ₹77,000 crore of outflows reported in the first half of March amid global volatility linked to the West Asia conflict. Varshney said the regulator would ease procedural and technical bottlenecks for Russian investors and may consider setting up dedicated working groups to address specific requirements. He also encouraged Russian companies to tap Indian markets through local listings. “We have seen some companies who have done that and their subsidiary’s valuation in India is more than the valuation of their parent company overseas,” he said. At present, 23 Russian en-



MAKING HAY. Kamlesh Chandra Varshney, Whole-time Member, SEBI, speaking at a Russia-India forum on capital market integration at the National Stock Exchange

tities, including banks and financial institutions, are registered as FPIs in India, with access to both equity and debt markets.

INDIA’S OFFERINGS Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD and CEO, NSE, said India offers a broader proposition for global issuers. “For Rus-

sian issuers, the proposition is broader still, because India’s markets can offer not only access to capital, but also the possibility of stronger valuation outcomes. India’s capital markets are not only financing growth at home, but are also becoming an increasingly important channel for long-

term international economic engagement,” he said. At the same event, Sergey Glazyev, State Secretary of the Union State of Russia and Belarus, called for the creation of “a new financial architecture which is based on national currency and international transparency and trust”. Sriram Krishnan, Chief Business Development Officer, NSE, said Russian firms could also explore fundraising through listings at Gift City, Gujarat and consider setting up banking presence in the international financial services hub. Separately, Varshney said SEBI is working with market participants on technology-led solutions to ease access and reduce the cost of doing business.

Basmati rice exporter Amir Chand sets IPO price band at ₹201-212, issue opens March 24

Press Trust of India New Delhi

Basmati rice exporter Amir Chand Jagdish Kumar (Exports) has fixed a price band of ₹201-212 per share for its upcoming initial public offering (IPO), valuing the company at ₹2,200 crore. The company on Thursday said its ₹440 crore maiden IPO will open for subscription on March 24 and conclude on March 27. Bidding for investors is scheduled to take place on March 23. The Haryana-based company’s proposed IPO will comprise an entirely fresh is-



AROMATIC AFFAIR. Rahul Suri (right), Whole Time Director, Amir Chand Jagdish Kumar (Exports)

sue of equity shares, with no offer for sale (OFS) component. It plans to utilise the net proceeds to fund its working

capital requirements and for general corporate purposes. The offer size has been reduced to ₹440 crore, compared with the ₹550 crore is-

sue size proposed in the Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP) filed in June 2025. The SEBI granted its approval for the IPO in October 2025.

MARKET TAKE-OFF The company raised ₹13 crore in a pre-IPO round by allotting 7.55 lakh shares at ₹172 per share. It markets its products under the flagship brand “Aeroplane”. The company has diversified into FMCG products, offering staples and other essential kitchen items. The basmati rice exporter will make its stock market debut on April 2.

Choice MF opens NFOs for two Nifty index funds

Our Bureau Mumbai

Choice Mutual Fund, sponsored by Choice International, launched a new fund offer (NFO) for two passive index funds on Thursday — the Choice Nifty 50 Index Fund and the Choice Nifty Next 50 Index Fund. The NFO closes on April 2. The Nifty 50 Index Fund tracks India’s top 50 blue-chip companies and is positioned as a core, SIP-driven equity holding. The Nifty Next 50 Index Fund tracks the subsequent tier of emerging large-cap companies.

Powerica plans ₹1,100 crore IPO, fixes price band at ₹375-395

Avinash Nair Ahmedabad

Mumbai-based Powerica Ltd sold 7,689 diesel generator (DG) sets powered by Cummins engines in FY25, highlighting surging demand for reliable power in India’s industrial and commercial sectors. Now, the integrated power solutions provider is gearing up for its ₹1,100 crore initial public offering, aiming to fuel growth in high-demand segments, such as data centres and electric vehicle (EV) charging infrastructure. Even as India pushes forward with clean energy, uninterrupted power remains critical. Data centre capacity is set to soar from 1.4 GW in FY25 to 4.7 GW by FY30, while EV charging demand is projected to jump from 3.6 GW to 10.8 GW.

IPO DETAILS

Powerica is coming to market with an IPO in a price band of ₹375-₹395 per share, including a fresh issue of



Bharat Oberoi, chairman and managing director, Powerica

₹700 crore and an offer-for-sale of ₹400 crore by the promoter entities. Powerica plans to use a significant portion of the IPO proceeds to repay debt, thereby reducing outstanding borrowings of ₹1,214.25 crore as of February 2026. “We are selling more KVA (kilovolt-amperes) than we sold last year. Now, data centres and EV charging infrastructure are expected to drive future growth of the company,” Bharat Oberoi, Chairman and Managing Director, Powerica, told *businessline* during his visit to Ahmedabad on Thursday.

While the sale of DG sets worth over ₹1,870 crore accounted for 70 per cent of the company’s revenues in FY25, the company has already sold 4,194 DG sets worth ₹920 crore in the first half of FY26. “We are supplying DG sets for data centres in Mumbai, Hyderabad, Chennai and Delhi. The biggest one which we will be completing is in Navi Mumbai,” Oberoi added.

EV CHARGING INFRA

With EV charging networks expected to multiply five-fold by 2030, demand for backup power is only set to rise. As EV charging networks expand, from about 20,000 stations currently to 1,00,000-1,50,000 by 2030, pressure on local grids is expected to intensify. This is likely to drive further demand for standby DG systems. “Though the diesel generator market in India is growing at 10.5 per cent CAGR, the demand for diesel generators at data centres is growing at 24 per cent,” he added.

Paras Healthcare ‘revives’ \$200 m public issue plans, appoints advisers

Bloomberg

Paras Healthcare has revived plans for an initial public offering (IPO) and hired three banks for a share sale that could raise as much as \$200 million, according to people familiar with the matter. The Gurugram-based hospital chain has appointed JM Financial, BofA Securities and Nuvama Wealth Management as advisers for the proposed listing, the people said, asking not to be identified. APPROVAL LAPSE Paras Healthcare had previously filed draft papers for an IPO in July 2024 and received approval from SEBI in October that year. The company, however,

A recent sell-off in equities after the outbreak of war in West Asia has added to challenges for firms planning IPOs

did not proceed with the listing and the approval lapsed in October 2025. The hospital chain has replaced all the bankers who advised them in 2024. Deliberations are ongoing and details such as the size of the offering could still change, the people said. Representatives for Paras Healthcare and the three banks didn’t respond to requests for comment. A recent sell-off in equit-

ies following the outbreak of war in West Asia has added to challenges for companies seeking to go public, raising the prospect of a slowdown in issuance after two record-breaking years. IPOs have raised about \$1.8 billion so far this quarter, compared with \$2.3 billion in the same period last year, according to Bloomberg data. Founded in 2006 with its first hospital in Gurugram, Paras Healthcare now operates eight multi-super specialty hospitals under the Paras Health brand. Its IPO would add to a growing number of deals in Asia’s healthcare industry, including an offering by Malaysia’s Sunway Healthcare Bhd, which raised 2.86 billion ringgit (\$731 million).

BROKER’S CALL.

Emkay Global

UJJIVAN SFB (BUY)

Target: ₹72 CMP: ₹52.48 We hosted a call with Vibhas Chandra, Head- MFI and Gold loans, Ujivan SFB, along with the IR team, to discuss growth/asset-quality trends and potential impact of the proposed Bihar MFI Ordinance, upcoming multi-State elections, and business disruption due to the ongoing US-Iran conflict. The management indicated that growth and asset-quality recovery are on track for now across States, while it expects minimal impact from seasonal factors (heat wave) or the restricted movement around the elections, in Q1. On the other hand, the impact of the MFIN guardrail is decelerating, with the three-plus lender portfolio set to become virtually zero over coming quarters. The impact of the recently-reported partial shutdown of restaurants and small businesses too is expected to be limited, assuming that the geo-political situation stabilises soon. As part of its long-standing strategy, Ujivan plans accelerating growth in secured lending (including gold loans) without diluting credit filters, building on its initial portfolio experience. The management indicated that the MFI and gold loan portfolios have about 40 per cent customer overlap, which it plans to gradually diversify. On the ‘Universal Bank’ licence, the management remains hopeful based on reduced RBI query intensity, though it has not committed to any timeline. We retain BUY on the stock with December 2026E TP of ₹72 (implying 1.6x FY28E ABV).

Elara Securities

LG ELECTRONICS INDIA (ACCUMULATE) Target: ₹1,750 CMP: ₹1,526.80 LG Electronics India (LGEL) expects FY26 revenue to be flat or grow at a modest pace of 2-3 per cent (9MFY26 revenue down 2 per cent year on year), in-line with its guidance. Thus, expect Q4 revenue to grow by high single- to double-digits. The company expects low double-digit margin in FY26, implying Q4FY26 margin within 12.5-13.5 per cent range, with price hikes of 7-9 per cent in room air conditioners (RACs) in January, led by a premium mix and good sales of non-RAC categories. LGEL had hiked price by 2 per cent for washing machines and refrigerators in Q3FY26. LGEL has sufficient LPG inventory until the first week of April for RACs and refrigerators. If LPG shortage persists, it would substitute a portion of manufacturing (about 30 per cent) with oxy acetylene brazing and PNG brazing. There is no impact on cost, as PNG is cheaper than LPG. The only drawback is longer brazing time and certain carbon and aluminium deposits left in the heat exchanger from acetylene brazing. LPG shortage will not impact washing machines and TV manufacturing at all. We maintain Accumulate with a TP of ₹1,750 on 45x FY28 P/E on account of market leadership in most durable categories, industry-leading margins, higher premium contribution versus peers and growth plans of raising exports, B2B and AMC contribution, and foray into the economy segment.

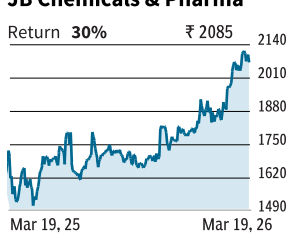
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY’S PICK.

JB Chemicals & Pharma (₹2,085.10): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu bl. research bureau

JB Chemicals & Pharma



The stock of JB Chemicals & Pharmaceuticals has been in a steady uptrend since October last year. Although there have been several price corrections, the scrip has been maintaining the broader uptrend. In the recent sessions, the stock has largely stayed flat, moving between ₹2,080 and ₹2,140. The 21-day moving average is now at ₹2,070. Therefore, the price band of ₹2,070-2,080 is a support band. We expect the stock to resume the rally on the back of this. In the near-term, the price can touch ₹2,200. Therefore, traders can buy the stock now

at ₹2,085 and place a stop-loss at ₹2,035. When the price hits ₹2,140, revise the stop-loss to ₹2,090. On a rally to ₹2,180, alter the stop-loss to ₹2,150. Book profits at ₹2,200. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23128 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
23000	22800	23300	23600	Go long if there is a recovery above 23300; stop-loss at 23100.	
₹799 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
785	770	815	845	Go long if the stock surpasses 815; place stop-loss at 785.	
₹1220 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1215	1180	1230	1250	Trend is bearish but the stock is now at a support; stay out.	
₹298 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
295	290	302	305	Go short when the price rises to 300; place stop-loss at 305.	
₹269 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
267	262	270	275	Buy if the stock breaks out of 270; stop-loss can be at 265.	
₹1385 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1370	1340	1415	1435	Intraday trend is uncertain for the stock; hence stay away.	
₹1048 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1042	1030	1076	1100	Stock might see a recovery; go long with a stop-loss at 1030.	
₹2356 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2350	2300	2410	2475	Direction of intraday trend unclear at the moment; stay out.	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

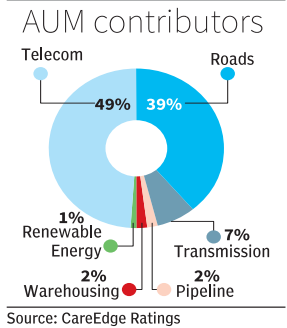
‘InvITs’ AUM to grow ₹1 lakh crore in FY26’

Our Bureau Chennai

Assets under management (AUM) of Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) are likely to grow by ₹1 lakh crore during FY26, said CareEdge Ratings. InvITs have gained momentum with AUM doubling from about ₹3 lakh crore in FY22 to around ₹6.25 lakh crore by FY25, said the ratings major in a note. The number of InvITs in India has also increased from 11 in FY22 to 22 in FY25, reflecting both structural investor appetite and the rapid institutionalisation of operational infrastructure platforms. However, sectoral dispersion is yet to catch up, it said, adding that AUM remains heavily concentrated in two segments — telecom (₹3.06 lakh crore) and roads (₹2.46 lakh crore) — which together account for nearly 90 per cent of the industry’s AUM as of March 31, 2025, signalling diversification. CareEdge Ratings expects InvIT AUM to grow, led by portfolio expansion across roads, transmission, warehousing and renewable energy sectors in FY26.

“The medium-term trajectory will also benefit from the strong National Monetisation Pipeline-II (NMP-II), the pool of operational HAM assets and increasing activity on transmission and warehousing platforms.” InvITs have mobilised ₹88,000-crore equity during the past three years, FY23-FY25, and are expected to further raise ₹16,500 crore in FY26. “InvITs are expected to witness another year of steady growth in FY26, with nearly ₹1 lakh crore of additional AUM driven by the roads, warehousing, transmission, and renewable energy sectors. The sector’s credit profile remains robust, supported by diversified, operational asset pools. However, there remains significant potential to enhance creditor protections further and deepen the domestic investor base, particularly given the currently low participation by retail investors, mutual funds, and insurance companies,” said Maulesh Desai, Director at CareEdge Ratings.

“Leverage levels are expected to remain stable at around 49 per cent in FY26, aided by valuation gains and continued equity issuances. Bond market participation is likely to stay moderate, representing approximately 20 per cent of the estimated ₹3.70 lakh crore in debt as of March 31, 2026,” he added.



continues to show a clear reliance on banks, with term loans accounting for nearly two-thirds of total borrowings as of March 31, 2025. Bond issuances, despite gradual progress, account for only about 20 per cent of the combined debt, highlighting an under-penetrated capital market base even as platforms mature.

OUTLOOK, LOOPHOLES “InvITs are expected to witness another year of steady growth in FY26, with nearly ₹1 lakh crore of additional AUM driven by the roads, warehousing, transmission, and renewable energy sectors. The sector’s credit profile remains robust, supported by diversified, operational asset pools. However, there remains significant potential to enhance creditor protections further and deepen the domestic investor base, particularly given the currently low participation by retail investors, mutual funds, and insurance companies,” said Maulesh Desai, Director at CareEdge Ratings.

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Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 775.65 pts.					
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)	
ONGC	269.10	3.49	7.53	1.00	
Coal India	454.20	-0.50	9.41	0.98	
HDFC Life	633.50	-9.32	72.31	0.65	
PowerGrid Corp	296.70	-2.68	17.78	1.28	
Dr Reddys Lab	1274.50	-2.71	19.26	0.74	
NestleIndia	1186.30	-2.91	70.14	0.81	
Cipla	1239.20	-3.62	22.08	0.66	
Wipro	188.41	-3.69	14.82	0.51	
Adani Enter	1936.80	-4.02	15.82	0.48	
Max Healthcare	953.10	-4.36	51.78	0.88	
TataConsumerProduct	1044.60	-4.36	70.25	0.65	
NTPC	374.05	-4.63	14.61	1.69	
Apollo Hosp	7252.00	-4.95	55.89	0.71	
SBI Life	1903.10	-5.85	76.98	0.81	
Tech Mahindra	1340.60	-6.21	28.61	0.81	
Jo Financial Services Ltd.	239.45	-6.29	94.79	0.75	
Eicher Motors	6793.00	-7.08	34.78	0.89	
Tata Motors PV	309.30	-7.09	42.06	0.62	
Adani Ports	1356.00	-7.43	25.00	0.95	
Asian Paints	2186.00	-7.55	53.63	0.94	
Trent Ltd.	3481.90	-7.74	76.41	0.74	
Sun Pharma	1744.40	-7.87	38.21	1.76	
Tata Steel	190.51	-8.89	26.91	0.94	
Bharat Elec	430.80	-9.27	52.81	1.47	
Bajaj Finserv	1714.90	-9.65	14.27	0.94	
Grasim Ind	2607.90	-9.65	18.74	0.95	
Titan	403.90	-9.74	75.22	1.59	
Bajaj Auto	8868.50	-9.79	27.88	0.94	
JSW Steel	1130.90	-10.18	35.61	1.01	
Intellopharm	4154.30	-12.54	50.02	0.90	
HCL Tech	1311.80	-10.51	21.61	1.32	
UltraTech Cement	10814.00	-11.26	41.58	1.22	
Hind Unilever	2077.30	-11.29	48.54	1.76	
Hindalco	897.05	-11.43	12.54	1.24	
Kotak Bank	368.15	-11.70	19.48	2.58	
ITC	298.90	-12.03	18.30	2.74	
Maruti Suzuki	12599.00	-12.93	26.53	1.58	
Bharti Airtel	1827.00	-17.36	28.12	4.86	
TCS	2356.00	-19.00	17.77	2.29	
State Bank	1048.90	-19.02	11.19	4.15	
Eternal Ltd.	228.74	-21.75	95.59	1.57	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	943.01	-22.06	19.54	1.27	
Bajaj Finance	832.20	-27.90	28.26	2.11	
Axis Bank	1207.00	-29.05	14.19	3.30	
M&M	3045.40	-33.14	22.40	2.59	
Reliance Ind	1384.80	-34.51	19.17	8.92	
Infosys	1220.80	-35.58	17.68	4.08	
L&T	3434.50	-44.67	24.90	3.85	
ICI Bank	1250.10	-63.42	15.79	1.54	
HDFC Bank	798.20	-150.51	15.86	11.64	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 2,094.70 pts.

	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)
Bajaj Housing Finance .	81.75	-3.76	27.49	0.36
Jsw Energy .	505.90	-5.15	33.96	1.28
Tata Power	398.50	-9.32	25.43	3.16
Lic	766.05	-13.19	9.14	0.80
Avenuesuper	3808.20	-15.82	86.52	2.65
Hyundai Motor India .	1951.50	-16.64	27.39	1.31
Indian Railway Finance Corp	95.04	-17.21	17.73	0.80
Zyduslisciences	876.15	-17.61	17.54	1.03
Abb India	6214.00	-19.43	78.08	1.54
Magzapan Dock	2861.40	-21.77	39.58	0.85
Bosch	30135.00	-22.54	32.24	1.23
Siemens Energy India .	2755.20	-22.66	83.06	1.15
Shree Cement	23335.00	-23.67	46.88	1.47
Bajaj Holdings	9674.00	-24.03	12.01	1.98
Torrent Pharma	4218.00	-24.63	62.73	2.08
United Spirits .	1288.90	-27.82	54.50	1.80
Limnited	4178.50	-27.91	26.35	1.84
Info Edge	970.60	-28.33	37.25	1.78
ICICI Lombard Cg	1792.10	-28.40	32.63	2.05
Macrotech Developers .	81.75	-30.55	24.42	0.99
Adani Energy Solutions .	1055.30	-32.68	50.66	1.65
AdaniGreenenergy	804.90	-33.48	75.87	2.14
Adani Power .	151.01	-36.22	54.77	1.81
Gaestel	126.05	-37.53	25.75	1.54
Punjab Natl Bank	109.49	-37.55	7.04	1.78
Siemens	3079.00	-37.63	69.12	1.98
Godrej Consumer	1022.20	-38.15	59.42	1.94
Amulja Cements	41.95	-38.97	21.09	1.21
Solar Industries	13159.00	-39.47	77.99	1.51
Windsor	59.25	-40.13	38.12	1.64
Hindus Zinc	596.15	-40.30	10.11	0.94
Cg Power & Ind Sol	686.70	-42.93	97.47	2.23
Vinard Beverages .	40.65	-42.91	44.69	2.61
Jindal Steel	1138.10	-46.08	57.59	2.01
Canara Bank	132.92	-46.43	61.02	2.11
Rural Electr	104.87	-54.06	11.55	1.84
Central Cg	333.40	-54.50	5.09	1.97
Bank Of Baroda	272.60	-58.72	7.18	2.39
Indian Hotels Co. .	613.65	-61.40	40.36	2.54
Indian Oilcorp	142.73	-62.10	5.47	2.52
Divis Lab	5972.50	-63.85	63.96	3.58
Britania	563.35	-69.47	15.70	5.33
Vedanta	1308.90	-70.34	57.56	2.92
Volcom	6675.50	-74.84	56.55	3.16
SamvardhanaInternatnrl	111.75	-80.35	32.41	2.34
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3454.20	-83.55	53.34	3.83
CholamandaminiFin	1455.10	-89.68	25.33	2.90
Power Finance	111.85	-89.12	4.07	2.83
Cholamandaramatics	2602.50	-90.57	28.59	4.40
Bpcl	286.10	-102.93	5.04	2.62

QUICKLY.

Palm oil closes more than 1% higher



Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures settled more than 1 per cent higher on Thursday, extending gains to a third consecutive week, as firmer Dalian oils supported market, while profit-taking limited gains in a holiday truncated week. The benchmark palm oil contract for June delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange gained 84 ringgit to 4,612 ringgit a tonne at the close. REUTERS

Aluminium prices slide 8% as bullish bets decline

London: Aluminium prices tumbled 8 per cent on Thursday as speculators scrambled to liquidate bullish positions. Benchmark 3-month aluminium on the LME tumbled as much as 8.4 per cent, paring losses to 7.2 per cent at \$3,154.50 a tonne in official open-outcry trading. REUTERS
LME copper slid 3.8 per cent to \$11,925 a tonne in official activity.

Raw sugar hits 2-1/2 month high as oil surges



London: Raw sugar futures on the ICE rose to a 7-week high on Thursday, as speculators grew increasingly bullish after the escalating Iran war pushed oil prices near a three-and-a-half-year peak. Raw sugar rose 2.8 per cent to 15.21 cents per pound at 1345 GMT, after hitting its highest since late December at 15.26 cents. REUTERS

Gold prices plunge by ₹700/g

LOSING SHINE. Global prices of the yellow metal crash by over \$250 and white metal by \$7.5 an ounce

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Gold and silver prices crashed in the Indian domestic market on cues from the global market, where the Middle East conflict increased energy prices and ignited inflation concerns. It led to hopes of leading central banks keeping interest rates higher.

In the domestic market, gold prices dropped by 4.5 per cent or ₹6,990 to ₹147,889 per 10 g against ₹1,54,879 at close on Wednesday, following the bearish sentiments in the global markets.

Opening on a weak note at ₹151,637, the yellow metal continued to its downtrend with no buying support, according to Indian Bullion and Jewellers Association of India data on Thursday.

At 1915 hours IST, gold for April delivery on the MCX plunged by ₹9,966 to ₹1,43,049 per 10 g, while June contract dipped 8 per cent to ₹1,45,120. In the global market, gold nosedived by \$257 or nearly 8 per cent to \$4,561.90 an ounce.

On the COMEX, April gold contracts dropped to \$4,555.14 an ounce.

Prices have breached \$4,700 as the US Fed held interest rates steady at 3.50-3.75 per cent, signalling uncertainty over the inflationary and economic impact of rising oil prices.

Silver, on the other hand, fell to ₹2,29,873 per kg against ₹2,49,907 at closed on Wednesday.

On the MCX, silver for delivery in May dropped by ₹27,254 a kg to ₹2,20,940.

In the global market, silver slipped by nearly 10 per cent or over \$7 to \$69/18 an



MARKET STRESS. Despite ongoing geopolitical tensions, bullion remained under pressure as markets focused on higher interest rates amid persistent inflation risks REUTERS

ounce. On COMEX, silver May futures decreased to \$69.34, a fall over over 10 per cent.

Manav Modi, Commodities Analyst, Motilal Oswal Financial Services, said despite the ongoing geopolitical tensions, bullion remained under pressure as the markets focused on the likelihood of interest rates amid

persistent inflation risks.

CRUDE ABOVE \$100

Crude oil prices remained elevated above \$100 per barrel as the US-Israel conflict with Iran showed no signs of easing, he said. While the Fed maintained its long-term inflation target of 2 per cent, markets now expect policymakers to remain cautious,

limiting upside in gold despite ongoing haven demand, he said.

Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst-Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities, said gold witnessed a steep decline of over \$100 in a single session and nearly \$300 in the last two days due to strong macro headwinds continue to weigh on prices.

Despite geopolitical tensions typically supporting haven demand, the current environment is dominated by inflation-led policy tightening expectations.

Rising oil prices are further reinforcing inflation risks, reducing the likelihood of near-term rate cuts, he said.

Renisha Chainani, Head of Research at Augmont, said gold and silver remain under pressure as elevated real yields continue to cap upside.

Gold outshines bonds as portfolio diversifier: WGC

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai



RUPEE PRESSURE. Periods of rupee depreciation tend to amplify gold price rises

Gold has emerged the best portfolio diversification with the recent trend of bonds and equities moving in tandem. Historically, government bonds exhibit a negative correlation with equities, helping balance portfolio risks. However, over the past few years, the equity-bond relationship has turned increasingly positive.

In contrast, gold has continued to predominantly display a negative correlation with equities across most periods, reinforcing its role as an effective diversifier during market stress, according to the recent World Gold Council (WGC) report.

While the broad-based strength of economic activity suggests that the growth

momentum is likely to persist, risks to the outlook stem largely from external uncertainties — spillover from geopolitical tensions, volatility in the global financial markets and uncertain global economic prospects — all of which have intensified since the beginning of 2026.

The implications of the ongoing West Asia conflict are particularly significant for India. Beyond its resilience during periods of uncertainty, gold has delivered long-term returns across economic cycles.

WGC analysis shows that gold complements equities and broad-based portfolios by providing a unique combination of returns and diversification. These characteristics help improve portfolio resilience by en-

hancing risk-adjusted returns, reducing volatility and limiting drawdowns, it said.

Over a 19-year period, an average portfolio would have delivered higher risk-adjusted returns and lower drawdowns with gold allocations in the range of 7.5 per cent to 15 per cent, underscoring its value as a core portfolio component, said the report.

DOMESTIC PRICES

Movements in domestic gold prices reflect global market dynamics, import duty and exchange rate movements. With gold priced internationally in dollar, the value of the rupee can significantly influence its domestic price. Periods of rupee depreciation tend to amplify gold price rises.

Over longer horizons, the depreciation of the rupee has, therefore, contributed

meaningfully to gold's return profile. This becomes increasingly relevant during periods of stress, when capital flows and exchange rates tend to be volatile. During such times, gold provides additional protection against uncertainty as well as from currency risk within portfolios.

Kavita Chacko, Research Head, India-World Gold Council, said an environment of elevated geopolitical tensions, shifting market correlations and persistent currency risks underscores the importance of resilient portfolios.

Gold's performance across market cycles, its diversification attributes and its ability to provide protection during periods of financial stress reinforce its strategic, long-term relevance within portfolios.

Eleve Diamonds to open shop in Coimbatore

Our Bureau
Chennai

Eleve Diamonds, the lab-grown diamonds arm of the Hyderabad-based traditional jeweller Tibarumal Jewels, plans to launch its store in Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, soon, besides adding another in the Telangana capital, its Founder Trishank Gupta said.

"We currently have five stores that are operational. Four of them are in Hyderabad and one in Warangal," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

US ENTRY

Eleve Diamonds is in talks for new franchisee opportunities in Chennai and Delhi. "We do look to expand in the South for now predominantly but if we get opportunities, we are open to North and anywhere in India

as such," said Gupta.

Eleve has not looked at exports of its lab-grown diamonds, particularly in the US. There are two reasons for this. The first is due to the tariff issue. The second is that it does not have a flagship store there.

The US branch of Tibarumal is doing well, and they plan to launch Eleve there too. "We are in talks over that, and it might happen very soon," he said, adding that the US market is promising for lab-grown diamonds, even more than India.

"That is on the cards. We are looking for that opportunity. It will be done within this coming financial year, hopefully. We are look at Dubai too," said the Eleve Diamonds Founder.

Tibarumal, founded 104 years ago in Hyderabad, was launched to cater to the Nizams.

BOUNTIFUL HARVEST



PRICE UP. Farmers thresh paddy crops using a thresher at a field in Dasna, Ghaziabad. The weighted average price of paddy in the country is currently ₹2,681 a quintal against the minimum support price of ₹2,545. During the same time a year ago, the price was ₹2,208. Rice production is expected to be at a new high of over 152 million tonnes ANI

BL Agro arm achieves 65% success in India's first indigenous cow embryo transfer programme

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Leads Genetics, a subsidiary of food company BL Agro, has announced that it has achieved 65 per cent success in its largescale indigenous Cow Embryo Transfer programme, the first such initiative in the private sector in India. It conducted in-vitro fertilisation (IVF) in 116 cows in December 2025.

The cows received embryo of India's Gir bull, which was imported from Brazil and 75 have reported positive results. Brazilian Gir cows are descendants of India's Gir that were exported in the 20th Century. Their semen is imported as the milk yield is at least thrice higher than the Indian breed.

As three months have



OPTIMISTIC OUTPUT. Of the 116 cows that received the embryo of Gir bull, 75 have reported positive results

passed, company officials do not expect any risk till August when the cows will give birth to calves — 65 female and 10 male.

Terming it a historic moment for India's dairy industry since it had become the first private company to carry out the largescale indigenous cow embryo transfer, BL Agro's MD Ashish Khandelwal said the success could accelerate India's journey to-

ward becoming a global leader in per cow dairy productivity and livestock genetics. "Leads Genetics and BL Agro are committed to bringing world-class science to the service of our farmers and rural communities," he said.

SECOND PHASE

Speaking to *businessline* from Bareilly, Uttar Pradesh, where the IVF programme is

being conducted at its Centre of Excellence of Cattle breeding and Dairying Technology, Khandelwal, who is also a Director with Leads Genetics, said in the second phase, 171 cows had undergone IVF and over 400 more would be completed by the end of this month.

He said there are 600 cows of Gir, Sahiwal and HF cross breeds already available at the Centre while 100 are expected to join in a day or two.

The company is currently evaluating the conditions of 41 cows who could not conceive or there was miscarriage in the first phase, and those will also again receive the semen through IVF if they are found fit by doctors. The Gujarat Gir breed is known for its superior milk yield, adaptability to climate, and disease resistance.

Telangana govt to promote natural farming on 61,125 acres at ₹42 cr

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

With a view to promoting natural farming in the State, the Telangana government has chalked out a plan to groom over 61,125 farmers in relevant farm management techniques.

The government will develop 489 clusters, totalling 61,125 acres across different parts of the State, in the upcoming agricultural year. Each cluster will be guided by two 'Krishi Sakhi' (farm guides).

The government has earmarked ₹42 crore for the initiative, which will be launched at Narmetta in Siddhipet district on Friday (March 20), according to Telangana Agriculture, Marketing and Cooperation Min-



ister Tummala Nageshwara Rao.

RYTHU BHAROSA

"Telangana aspires to be a model State in natural farming. We have identified 61,125 farmers for this programme. They are being trained in the newer farming methods. The Krishi Sakhis will get a honorarium of ₹5,000 each a month," he said.

Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy will disburse the Rythu Bharosa funds (₹9,000

Over 40% of major storages are half empty

Our Bureau
Chennai

Storage in over 40 per cent of India's 166 major reservoirs was less than 50 per cent of the capacity this week, even as the level in all the dams declined to 51 per cent.

The situation comes at a time when over 70 per cent of the country has received deficient or no rainfall since the beginning of this year.

According to the Central Water Commission (CWC), the major reservoirs were filled to 51 per cent of the 183.565 billion cubic metres (BCM) capacity at 94.063 BCM.

According to India Meteorological Department (IMD) data received from 726 districts, 78 per cent of the country received deficient or no rainfall since March 1.

1 RESERVOIR FULL

Among the 166 reservoirs, the level in 39 was below 40 per cent and in 33 below 50 per cent of the capacity. Only the Jakhet hill reservoir in Jharkhand is filled to capacity, while the level in 18 was above 80 per cent.

The level in the Western, Eastern and Central regions was above 50 per cent, while in the South, the storage was lower than last year. Overall, the storage is 13.5 percentage points higher than last year and 26 per cent more than normal (last 10 years storage).

The 47 reservoirs in the Southern region were filled to a little over 41 per cent of the 55.288 BCM capacity at 22.830 BCM.

The level in Telangana dropped below 35 per cent, while in Karnataka, it was lower than 40 per cent of the capacity. It was below 45 per cent in Kerala and Tamil Nadu, where storage was lower than a year ago, while it was 49 per cent in Andhra Pradesh.

In the Northern region's



11 reservoirs, the storage was 45.5 per cent or 9.041 BCM of the 19.836 BCM capacity. The level in Himachal Pradesh slipped below 40 per cent, but it was above 55 per cent in Punjab and Rajasthan.

MODERATED DROP

The 27 reservoirs of the Eastern region were filled to 50 per cent of the 21.759 BCM capacity at 10.881 BCM. In Assam, the storage dropped below 20 per cent and in West Bengal to 25 per cent. Among other States, the level in Odisha was 52 per cent.

In the Western region, the level was nearly 62 per cent of the 38.094 BCM capacity at 23.522 BCM in the 53 reservoirs. Goa's lone reservoir had storage of over 65 per cent, while in Maharashtra and Gujarat, it was 63 per cent and 60 per cent, respectively.

In the Central region, the 28 reservoirs were filled to 57 per cent or 27.789 BCM of the 48.588 BCM capacity. The level in Chhattisgarh was 71 per cent and in Madhya Pradesh, it was 59 per cent.

In Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, storage was 51 per cent and 43 per cent, respectively.

With the IMD predicting rainfall in some regions, the drop in the reservoir levels will likely be a little slower than in the past few weeks.

Go long if natural gas breaks out of ₹308

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

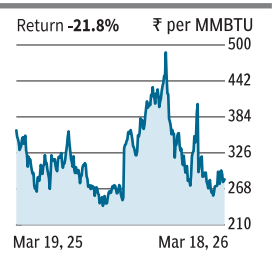
Natural gas futures have been very volatile since the beginning of this month. Nevertheless, currently trading at ₹296 (per mmBtu), the contract has been oscillating between ₹270 and ₹308 for nearly three weeks.

COMMODITY CALL.

Since the contract is now in a consolidation phase, there is uncertainty with respect to the direction of the next leg of trend.

If the bulls gather strength which leads to the breakout of ₹308, it will turn the outlook positive. In such a case, natural gas futures could rally to ₹350. The uptrend could even extend to ₹375.

On the other hand, if the contract slips below the sup-



port at ₹270, it could decline to ₹254 and then may be to ₹242. A fall below ₹242 is unlikely as the price band of ₹242-270 is a strong long-term base.

Considering the above factors, the direction of the next leg of trend is unclear now.

TRADE STRATEGY

Stay out for now. Buy natural gas futures (March) if it breaks out of ₹308. Place stop-loss at ₹295 at first. When the price rises to ₹330, tighten the stop-loss to ₹310. Exit at ₹340.

Iron ore futures dip as China eases port curbs on Jimblebar cargoes

Reuters
Singapore

Iron ore futures drifted lower on Thursday on easing supply pressures after China's State-backed buyer relaxed some restrictions on Jimblebar iron ore.

The most-traded May iron ore contract on China's Dalian Commodity Exchange (DCE) fell 0.55 per cent to 807.5 yuan (\$117.04) a tonne. The benchmark April iron ore on the Singapore Exchange firmed 0.24 per cent to \$107.05 a tonne as of 0704 GMT.

The easing of buying restrictions on BHP's Jimblebar cargoes already sitting at Chinese ports helped loosen supply concerns this week, pressuring prices.

Corn exports may gain due to war, other factors

KEY REASONS. Competitive pricing, strong regional demand and higher output poised to buoy shipments

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

India will likely export 6.5 lakh tonnes of corn (maize) during the current marketing year to September due to the Iran war and a slew of other factors.

According to the US Department of Agriculture, projections of corn exports have been raised from 3.5 lakh tonnes in view of competitive pricing, strong regional demand, higher production and a change in the use of grains for ethanol.

“Between October and December 2025, India exported about 4,00,000 tonnes of corn, double the volume for the same period in the last two years,” it said in its latest ‘Grains: World Markets and Trade’ report.

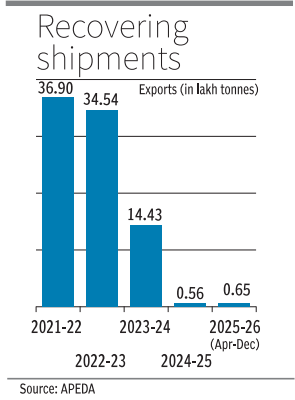
Corn exports surged to 3.69 million tonnes (mt) in

the 2021-22 fiscal year before declining to 0.56 mt in the last fiscal, according to data from the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority.

This year, shipments were pegged at 0.65 lakh tonnes in the first nine months of the current fiscal.

“Indian corn is offered to Bangladesh at \$220-230 a tonne. Brazil’s offers are at \$260 a tonne,” said Harish Bengani, Director of the Kolkata-based Bengani Commodities Private Limited. Bangladesh is looking for cheaper corn and is comfortable with Indian prices, he said.

M Madan Prakash, Director at the Chennai-based Rajathi Group, said corn is delivered from the Nashik area to Mumbai port and from the southern region to the Thoothukudi port at



₹19,000 a tonne. “At Mumbai, it is the old crop, while at Thoothukudi, it is the new crop which is in demand.”

Per data from Agmarknet, a unit of the Ministry of Agriculture, the weighted average price of wheat is currently ₹1,734.78 a quintal against the minimum support price of ₹2,400 fixed by the government. During the

same period last year, the price was ₹2,284.90.

The USDA said India’s corn harvest is forecast at a record 43 mt, up 1 mt more than 2024-25 and 5.3 mt higher than in 2023-24.

RECORD HARVESTS

According to the second advance estimates of the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers’ Welfare, corn production during the current crop year to June is pegged at a record high of 30.25 mt in the kharif season and at a new high of 15.9 mt in the rabi season.

At least another 3.5 mt could be harvested during the summer or *zaid* season. This year, the area under corn in the *zaid* season, as of March 13, is 22,000 hectares lower than last year at 2.96 lakh hectares.

A New Delhi-based trade analyst said corn is witness-

ing a rise in prices as the crop in Bihar has been delayed.

AWAITING BIHAR CROP

Bengani said exporters to Bangladesh are particularly awaiting the Bihar crop. “Bihar usually produces 2.2-2.5 mt of corn,” he said.

In addition, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh have reported good harvest, he said, adding that carryover stocks were ensuring ample supplies. “We are getting enquiries from Vietnam and Colombo (Sri Lanka),” said the Kolkata-based firm’s director.

Prakash said demand from Vietnam had increased after the Iran war broke out.

The USDA said corn production had increased due to the growth of the grain ethanol programme. Before 2023-24, most ethanol was made using sugarcane.

“To meet a 2025 deadline

for E20 implementation, India began sourcing significant amounts of ethanol feedstock from grains, particularly corn, which formed around 46 per cent of new ethanol feedstocks in 2024-25,” it said.

However, as rice supplies rebounded in 2025-26, the Indian government removed restrictions on the use of rice in ethanol production, shifting feedstock demand away from corn use.

This year, corn with 35 per cent moisture was sold at ₹12,000-13,000 a tonne in Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. “You wouldn’t believe there were no takers for it then,” said Bengani.

The USDA said this helped buyers in Vietnam get corn at \$230 a tonne in December. “India is expected to play a larger role in South and South-East Asia this year,” it said.

Maharashtra soybean buy done on time: Govt

Our Bureau
Pune

The soybean procurement process in Maharashtra was carried out on schedule and no farmer was refused procurement, Textile Minister Sanjay Savkare informed the Legislative Council during Question Hour.

The issue was raised by member Sadabhau Khot, with supplementary questions posed by members Pravin Darekar and Shashikant Shinde.

HIGHER THAN MSP

Savkare said online registration of farmers began on October 30, 2025, while actual procurement commenced on November 15. The procurement drive continued for 90 days and concluded on February 12, 2026.

The Minister noted that in some regions, procurement



targets were not fully met. He attributed this primarily to fluctuations in market prices, stating that many farmers opted to sell their produce in the open market after receiving better rates.

He said the State government’s minimum support price (MSP) procurement mechanism is aimed at ensuring farmers receive a minimum assured price and are protected from exploitation.

However, when market prices are higher than the MSP, farmers stand to benefit by selling their produce in the open market.

‘Cashew apple can boost farmers’ income via value addition’

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru

Participants at an industry interface meeting organised by the ICAR-Directorate of Cashew Research in Puttur, Dakshina Kannada district, said cashew apple, which is currently being wasted, could be an additional source of income for farmers if attention is given to value addition.

Speaking on the occasion, J Dinakara Adiga, Director of DCR, said India produces around 60 lakh tonnes of cashew apple every year.

Value addition is being done to only around 1 per cent of this, and a major por-

tion of cashew apple is being wasted in the country.

Highlighting the wastage of cashew apple, he said one hectare of cashew plantation produces around 1 tonne of cashew nuts and 8 tonnes of cashew apple.

A major chunk of this is being wasted now. Farmers will get additional income if value addition is done to cashew apple, he said.

NEW TECH

DCR, in association with the Karnataka Veterinary, Animal and Fisheries Sciences University (KVAFSU), is developing a technology to prepare fish feed from cashew apple pomace powder, he said.



UNEXPLOITED GEM. India produces around 60 lakh tonnes of cashew apple every year

DCR has developed technologies for the preparation clarified cashew apple juice, pasteurised cashew apple

juice, cashew apple liquid sweetener and cashew apple pomace tea, among others.

Shree Padre, a farm jour-

alist who is actively promoting cashew apple value addition, said it is being done to a significant portion of the cashew apple produce in countries like Brazil.

Urging the need to make a beginning in cashew apple value addition in India, he said a small step in this matter will go a long way in exploring the potential of cashew apple.

Stating that there is no grouse in fixing royalties by the institutes to transfer technologies to the stakeholders, he said, “It [royalties] should not be exorbitant to the level of discouraging start-ups or entrepreneurs from implementing it.”

IGC forecasts fall in global grains output in 2026-27

Reuters
London

The International Grains Council (IGC) on Thursday forecast that world grain production would fall in 2026-27, driven partly by an expected decline in output in the US, while also highlighting risks from the conflict in the Middle East. “Total supply is expected to contract for the first time in four seasons,” the IGC said in a monthly update.

The inter-governmental body put total grain production at 2.417 billion tonnes, down from 2.470 billion in 2025-26 and below the projected consumption of 2.440 billion.

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Telephone: +91 22 6731 0000, Email: mfservices@invescoindia.com; www.invescomutualfund.com

NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that Invesco Trustee Pvt. Ltd., **(the Trustee to Invesco Mutual Fund)** has approved the declaration of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal (**‘IDCW’**) in the following schemes, the particulars of which are as under:

Name of the Schemes	Plan(s) / Option(s)	Amount of IDCW* (Rs. per unit)	NAV as on March 18, 2026 (Rs. per unit)	Record Date#
Invesco India Focused Fund, an open ended equity scheme investing in maximum 20 stocks across market capitalization (i.e Multicap)	Regular Plan-IDCW Option	2.00	19.54	March 24, 2026
	Direct Plan-IDCW Option		21.43	
Invesco India Flexi Cap Fund, An open ended dynamic equity scheme investing across large cap, mid cap, small cap stocks	Regular Plan-IDCW Option	1.80	16.89	
	Direct Plan-IDCW Option		17.98	

*Distribution of the above IDCW is subject to the availability of distributable surplus and may be lower to the extent of distributable surplus available on the record date. IDCW payable to the unit holder(s) will be lower to the extent of tax deducted at source, at applicable rates.

#or immediately following Business Day if that day is not a Business Day.

Face Value per unit is Rs. 10/-.

Pursuant to payment of IDCW, the NAV of the IDCW Options of the aforesaid schemes would fall to the extent of payout and statutory levy, if any.

Unit holders of the aforesaid schemes, whose names appear in the records of the Registrar, KFin Technologies Limited, as at the close of business hours on **Tuesday, March 24, 2026** or immediately following Business Day if that day is not a Business Day (including valid purchase/switch-in application received till 3.00 p.m. on the record date, subject to the entire amount of subscription/ purchase as per the application / switch-in request is available for utilization by the schemes before the cut-off time on the record date) will be entitled to receive the IDCW.

Unit holders holding units in dematerialized (electronic) form whose names appear in the statement of beneficial owners maintained by the Depositories under the aforesaid schemes as at the close of business hours on **Tuesday, March 24, 2026** will be entitled to receive the IDCW.

With regard to Unit holders under IDCW options of the aforesaid schemes, who have opted for IDCW Reinvestment facility, the IDCW due will be reinvested by allotting units for the IDCW amount (net of applicable taxes and stamp duty) on the next Business Day after the Record Date) at a price based on the prevailing ex-IDCW NAV per unit on the record date.

For **Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.**
(Investment Manager for Invesco Mutual Fund)

Sd/-

Saurabh Nanavati

Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: March 19, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

ASIRVAD MICRO FINANCE LIMITED
Subsidiary of MANAPPURAM FINANCE LTD.
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Registered Office : Ceebros Manjula, 3rd Floor, Office No.1 New No.39., Old No : 45, Montieth Road, Egmore, Opp. Indian Red Cross Society, Chennai- 600008, Tamil Nadu, India.

JOINT PUBLIC NOTICE

This notice is jointly being issued by Asirvad Micro Finance Limited (“Company”), Manappuram Finance Limited (“MFL”), BC Asia Investments XXV Limited (“Investor 1”) and BC Asia Investments XIV Limited (“Investor 2”, and together with Investor 1 “Proposed Investors”) pursuant to Paragraph 8 of the Reserve Bank of India (Non-Banking Financial Companies – Acquisition of Shareholding or Control) Directions, 2025 dated 28 November 2025, as amended from time to time (“NBFC Shareholding and Control Directions”) and the RBI approval vide its letter dated 18 March, 2026

Background:

The Company is an Indian public company (and a subsidiary of MFL), incorporated under the Companies Act, 1956. The Company was incorporated on 29 August 2007 and has its registered office at Ceebros Manjula, 3rd Floor, Office No. 1, New No.39, Old No.45, Montieth Road, Egmore, Opp: Indian Red Cross Society, Chennai, Tamil Nadu - 600 008. The corporate identification number of the Company is U65923TN2007PLC064550. The Company is registered with the RBI as a non-banking financial company (“NBFC”) - Micro-Finance Institution, bearing registration number N-07-00769 dated 27 September 2016.

MFL, which is the holding company of the Company is a public listed company (BSE: 531213; NSE: MANAPPURAM, ISIN: INE522D01027), incorporated on 15 July 1992 under the Companies Act, 1956, and has its registered office at W-4/638A, Manappuram House, Valapad, Thirissur, Chavakkad, Kerala-680567. Its corporate identification number is L65910KL1992PLC006623. MFL is registered with the Reserve Bank of India (“RBI”) as a non-deposit taking NBFC – Investment Credit Company, pursuant to Certificate of Registration No. B-16.00029 dated 4 July 2011, issued by the RBI under Section 45-IA of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.

Investor 1 and Investor 2 are private limited companies incorporated on 14 October 2024 and 13 March 2023 respectively, under the laws of Mauritius. Their registered office is at Ground Floor, Block 3, The Strand, Lakeside District, Beau Plan, Mauritius.

Proposed Transaction:

1. On 20 March 2025, the Proposed Investors have entered into the securities subscription agreement and shareholders’ agreements (collectively, the “Transaction Documents”) with MFL, V.P. Nandakumar and Sushama Nandakumar (“Existing Promoters”) and certain members of the promoter group of MFL (collectively with the Existing Promoters, the “Specified Promoter and Promoter Group”) whereby:

(i) Investor 1 will acquire 9,29,01,373 fully paid-up equity shares of MFL; and (b) Investor 2 will acquire 9,29,01,373 warrants of MFL (“Subscription Warrants”), each carrying a right to subscribe to 1 (one) equity share of MFL, aggregating to 18% of the paid-up equity share capital of MFL (on a fully diluted basis, including pursuant to exercise and conversion of the Subscription Warrants); and

(ii) the Proposed Investors will acquire and exercise control along with the Existing Promoters over MFL and become co-promoters of MFL.

2. The execution of the Transaction Documents had also triggered the requirement to make a mandatory open offer to the public shareholders of MFL, to acquire up to 26% of the expanded voting share capital of MFL, in compliance with Regulations 3(1) and 4 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers) Regulations, 2011. Pursuant to the same, Investor 1 will acquire up to 24,42,27,387 fully paid-up equity shares of MFL from the public shareholders of MFL (“Open Offer”), subject to actual tendering of the equity shares of MFL by public shareholders in the Open Offer.

(the transactions in paragraphs 1 and 2 above being collectively referred to as “Proposed Transaction”). Pursuant to the Proposed Transaction, the Proposed Investors, in aggregate, will acquire up to a maximum of 41.66% of the paid-up equity share capital of MFL on a fully diluted basis, including pursuant to exercise and conversion of the Subscription Warrants, subject to actual tendering of the equity shares of MFL by the public shareholders of MFL in the Open Offer.

Further, as part of the Proposed Transaction the Proposed Investors and the Existing Promoters shall each have a right to nominate such number of non-executive and non-independent directors on the board of directors of the Company, proportionate to the number of their respective nominee directors on the board of MFL. As a consequence of the Proposed Transaction, there will also be an indirect change in control, and change in composition of the board of directors of the Company (resulting in change in more than 30% of the non-independent directors in the Company).

In this regard, the Proposed Investors propose to nominate 1 non-executive - non-independent director (i.e., Ms. Radhika Subramanian) on the board of directors of the Company (“Proposed Director”).

Rationale:

Through the Proposed Transaction, the Proposed Investors aim to (i) grow the revenue and profit of business portfolio, thereby increasing the consolidated return on equity and further diversifying the consolidated group revenue and profits into the financial services sector; (ii) help MFL and its subsidiaries on a professionalisation journey and build a professional management team that will enable it to drive better operational efficiency and risk management; and (iii) propel MFL and its subsidiaries’ efforts towards its broader objective of financial inclusion.

Approval: The RBI, in terms of its letters dated 26 August 2025 (bearing reference no. CHN.DoR.NRO.No. S184/05.02.001/2025-2026); and 18 March 2026 (bearing reference no. CHN.DoR.NRO.No. S446/05.01.001/2025-26) to the Company, has granted its approval to the Company for (a) change in the composition of the board of the Company due to the appointment of the Proposed Director, and (b) indirect change in control of the Company, respectively. This is subject to compliance with conditions specified therein. RBI has also granted dispensation regarding the period of public notice under Paragraph 8 of the NBFC Shareholding and Control Directions.

Accordingly, this public notice is being jointly issued by the Company, MFL, and the Proposed Investors with an intention to provide to the public, a notice / intimation regarding the proposed changes discussed above (including the particulars of the Proposed Investors and the rationale for the indirect change in control).

Any queries in this regard may be addressed to the Company to the Chief Compliance Officer of the Company, Mr. S. Sureshkumar (email id: cco@asirvad.in).

A copy of this notice is also available on the Company’s website at <https://asirvadmicrofinance.co.in/#>

Issued By

Sd/-
Authorised representative of Asirvad Micro Finance Limited

Sd/-
Authorised representative of Manappuram Finance Limited

Sd/-
Authorised representative of BC Asia Investments XXV Limited

Sd/-
Authorised representative of BC Asia Investments XIV Limited

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New Delhi: Shubham Housing Development Finance has raised \$96 million (about ₹870 crore) from existing investor LeapFrog Investments and others, including Creador. The transaction anchors Shubham's future growth with a strong shareholder base, while providing an exit to early investors, a joint statement said on Thursday. PTI

Stressing the need for systemic improvements, the CIC advised the UIDAI to lay down "clear timelines for disposal of such requests" and ensure that applications are processed in a "time-bound manner in accordance with applicable rules and regulations".

QUICKLY.

‘GIFT City competes with international hubs’

Gandhinagar: GIFT City now competes directly with financial hubs like Singapore, Dubai, London and New York, and has become a centre for realising the dreams of millions of youth in India, said Gujarat Deputy CM Harsh Sanghavi. The success of GIFT City lies in the unified regulatory architecture of International Financial Services Centres Authority, attractive tax structure and India’s digital financial strength, he said.

NTPC, Octopus to explore power sector opportunities

New Delhi: NTPC has signed an agreement with the UK-based Octopus Energy to explore business opportunities in electricity distribution and storage. The MoU was signed by Jatinder Singh Chandok, Head - International Business Development, NTPC, and Chris Fitzgerald, Group Director - International Affairs, Octopus Energy, on the sidelines of the Bharat Electricity Summit 2026.

Ahmedabad, Surat, Hyderabad ready to roll out e-buses under PM E-DRIVE

BID WINNERS. PMI Electro, EKA Mobility and Olectra have been issued letters of award

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Ahmedabad, Surat and Hyderabad have issued letters of award to bid winners, including PMI Electro, EKA Mobility and Olectra for the electric buses (e-buses) under the Prime Minister Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement (PM E-DRIVE) scheme, sources in the government told *businessline*, adding that the allocation for Delhi is expected soon.

The rollout of the e-buses in these cities is also expected soon, the official said. Under the PM E-DRIVE scheme, 14,028 e-buses are planned for seven cities — Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Pune and Surat, with a budget allocation of ₹4,391 crore — out of the total



GREEN TRANSIT. Under the PM E-DRIVE scheme, 14,028 e-buses are planned for Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Pune and Surat (file pic)

budget outlay of ₹10,900 crore in the PM E-DRIVE scheme.

“The companies had won the bids for Ahmedabad, Surat and Hyderabad, and the next step was that the States had to issue a letter of awards, which has been done now. The States have to pay the upfront costs and we will

provide the incentives as per the scheme guidelines,” a senior official at the Ministry of Heavy Industries told *businessline*.

INCENTIVE STRUCTURE As per the guidelines, for e-buses, the maximum incentive is fixed at ₹10,000 per kWh. However, there is a cap

on the maximum incentive based on the size of the vehicles.

For instance, for e-buses with a length of 10-12 m, the incentive is fixed at a maximum of ₹35 lakh/vehicle, and for medium e-buses (8-10 m), there is a cap of ₹25 l/vehicle.

Similarly, for mini e-buses

(6-8 m), the maximum incentive is fixed at ₹20 lakh/vehicle.

The tender of the scheme is being coordinated by Convergence Energy Services and operates under a gross cost contract model, where operators manage the vehicles and the cities pay on a per-km basis.

FLEET DISTRIBUTION

There are a total of 3,600 e-buses in this latest tender, with Hyderabad receiving the maximum allotment (2,000 e-buses), followed by Ahmedabad (1,000 units) and Surat (600 units). The rollout of these e-buses will happen till the second half of 2027.

In 2025, the first phase of the bidding was carried out, in which PMI Electro emerged as the largest winner nationwide, securing 5,210 buses out of around 10,900 e-buses in the tender.

‘Defence innovation picking up pace, contracts worth ₹6,179 crore inked’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday said innovation in defence has picked up pace, as 548 contracts have been signed over the past eight years. Of these, 58 prototypes have received clearance for procurement, valued around ₹3,853 crore; and 45 procurement contracts have already been signed, and these are worth nearly ₹2,326 crore.

He was addressing MSMEs, start-ups, winners of Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX), Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs), private defence companies, innovators, policymakers and academia during the inaugural session of the two-day National Defence Industries Conclave.

He described iDEX and ADITI (Acing Development of Innovative Technologies with iDEX) as game-changer initiatives, through which start-ups, innovators and MSMEs could develop solutions to meet the specific requirements of the defence forces. As of February 2026, about 676 start-ups, MSMEs and individual innovators have joined the defence innovation ecosystem since the inception of iDEX in 2018, he said.

‘MISSION MODE’

“548 contracts have been signed, and 566 challenges launched. Of these, 58 prototypes have received clearance for procurement, valued around ₹3,853 crore. Further, 45 procurement contracts have already been signed, worth nearly ₹2,326 crore. These figures demonstrate that innovation is gradually materialising into tangible products and technologies, and the role played by our start-ups and MSMEs in this transformation is steadily gaining strength,”



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh at the conclave

Singh said. MSMEs are today actively engaged in fields such as artificial intelligence, robotics, automation and advanced manufacturing, representing a positive transformation, he added.

Singh also emphasised the need to build a drone production ecosystem to ensure strategic autonomy, enhance defence preparedness and make the country self-reliant in view of the current geopolitical uncertainties.

“India must work in mission mode to emerge as a global hub of indigenous drone manufacturing in the next few years,” he stressed.

Singh launched the 14th edition of the Defence India Start-up Challenge (DISC-14) and the 4th edition of ADITI challenges under the iDEX framework.

About 107 problem statements, including 82 under DISC-14 and 25 under ADITI Challenges 4.0, from the defence forces, the Coast Guard and the Defence Space Agency were launched to promote breakthrough innovations in various domains.

Singh launched a new initiative, featuring 101 innovation challenges from DPSUs, to encourage design-led innovation by MSMEs and start-ups. These challenges are funded by DPSUs, which will also provide mentorship, testing facilities and opportunities for potential integration into their supply chains to the winning start-ups.

JN port brings down number of stranded containers by half

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Maharashtra has successfully reduced the number of stranded containers by half, even as global shipping dynamics remain affected by the ongoing West Asia war.

The progress follows a review and consultation meeting chaired by Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal on Thursday, which brought together key stakeholders, including shipping lines, terminal operators and trade bodies to discuss continuity, resilience and strategic adaptation in maritime operations.

Over the past 20 days, about 16,000 TEUs were dispatched from the port to destinations in West Asia, while around 1,700 TEUs returned to local terminals. The port is currently operating at around 50 per cent of its container storage capacity, the Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) said in an official release.

“During this period, the number of vessels at anchorage has significantly reduced from nine to four, indicating improved vessel clearance and operational efficiency. As of March 18, there are approximately 25,000 TEUs of transshipment containers unloaded for temporary storage at the port. The number of stranded contain-



SUPPORTING MEASURES. Anchorage for vessels awaiting transit to West Asia ports is also being provided free of charge

ers at JNPA has come down from around 5,000 TEUs on March 1 to nearly 2,500 TEUs of export containers, while perishable/refrigerated cargo has reduced from 2,000 TEUs to around 800 TEUs as of March 16,” the

JNPA added. To maintain smooth cargo movement, JNPA implemented several facilitation measures, including temporary transshipment storage for West Asia-bound cargo, additional storage allocation at termin-

als and priority handling for perishable cargo.

PROACTIVE STEPS

Customs authorities at the Jawaharlal Nehru Customs House (JNCH) now allow “brought to terminal” (BTT) movement of export cargo even without an export general manifest (EGM), with minimal inspections and waived charges.

Anchorage for vessels awaiting transit to West Asia ports, including Fujairah and Khor Fakkan in the UAE, and Sohar, Muscat and Salalah in Oman, is also being provided free of charge.

During the meeting, the discussions focused on ensuring the continuity of operations, minimising delays

and maintaining supply-chain resilience. Stakeholders shared on-ground insights and highlighted the measures being undertaken to manage evolving conditions, particularly with respect to export-import cargo movements to and from West Asian destinations.

Noting the government’s proactive measures to safeguard maritime trade, Sonowal stated, “Our ports have demonstrated resilience and capability in responding to emerging challenges — whether through efficient handling of diverted vessels, humanitarian assistance for international crew, or proactive trade facilitation measures at key ports, such as JNPA.”

AP govt releases job calendar to fill 10,060 vacancies

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

In what can be seen as a step to bring Ugadi cheer to job aspirants, the Andhra Pradesh government has released a job calendar to fill 10,060 posts in various departments for the year ahead.

“The job festival is being announced as a Ugadi gift for the youth of the State, fulfilling the promise made in the Yuva Galam Padayatra,” Nara Lokesh, Andhra Pradesh Minister for Human Resource Development, said in a post on social media platform X on Thursday.

EXAM TIMELINE

The release of the notifications and examinations would be conducted in line with the schedule given in the job calendar, he said, adding that a job calendar would be released every year on Ugadi.

According to the calendar, the issue of notifications will



Nara Lokesh, Minister for Human Resource Development, Andhra Pradesh

begin from May 15, to fill 1,500 vacancies in higher education, while the notifications for recruitment for posts in Group 1 and Group II cadre, Engineering, Home, Education and other departments have been scheduled in August, September and October.

REGISTRATION

The syllabus for all examinations will also be released soon. Job aspirants should register their details on the Naipunya portal of the State government.

200 mineral blocks auctioned in 2025-26; Tamil Nadu, Uttarakhand enter the fray

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Centre, on Thursday, said it has sold a record 200 mineral blocks in 2025-26, the highest ever in a single year, with Tamil Nadu conducting auctions for the first time and Uttarakhand entering the fray by selling its maiden magnesite block.

Out of the 200 auctioned blocks, 123 are mining lease blocks and 77 are composite licence blocks, indicating a balanced mix of operational and exploration-focused opportunities. Additionally, notices inviting tenders for 70 mineral blocks — 38 mining leases and 32 composite licences — are currently underway, which is likely to further boost the total number of successful auctions in the financial year.

TOP CONTRIBUTORS

Gujarat led with 32 blocks, followed by Rajasthan (30

Gujarat with 32 blocks, followed by Rajasthan (30 blocks) and Tamil Nadu (22 blocks) emerged as the top contributors

blocks) and Tamil Nadu (22 blocks) emerging as the top contributors, the Mines Ministry said.

Their efforts in timely block preparation, data management and procedural efficiency have strengthened the national auction ecosystem.

The Ministry added that this year, 22 critical mineral blocks were auctioned, reflecting the increasing focus on minerals of strategic importance for long-term resource security. Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Karnataka and Maharashtra played a major role in offering these blocks.

Jammu & Kashmir scales up e-NAM trade volumes with inter-State shipments

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

A shipment of 11 tonnes of apples and pears from Kashmir Valley reached the Gultekdi APMC (Agricultural Produce Market Committee) in Pune, Maharashtra, in August 2025, marking one of the first inter-State trades from Jammu and Kashmir under the Government of India’s National Agriculture Market (e-NAM) platform.

The delivery underscores the Union Territory’s increasing integration with national agricultural markets through digital mandi networks.

DIGITAL SHIFT

Since its rollout in Jammu and Kashmir, the e-NAM platform has gradually gained traction among farmers and traders.

In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers



ONLINE DEALS. The Union Territory’s e-NAM trade volumes went up from ₹89 lakh in 2021-22 to ₹32 crore by 2023

Welfare Bhagirath Choudhary on Tuesday noted that 17 mandis in the Union Territory had been linked to the national digital market, collectively facilitating trade worth ₹1,736 crore since the platform’s introduction.

Over 52,000 farmers are now registered on the e-NAM platform in the region, and about 2.9 lakh tonnes of produce have been traded digitally as of February 2026, according to the Minister’s reply.

Jammu and Kashmir has expanded its e-NAM trade volumes from a modest ₹89 lakh in 2021-22 to ₹32 crore by 2023, highlighting the growing adoption of online agricultural marketing among local growers.

VALUE ADDITION

“Proper grading and packaging of apples and other perishables could significantly boost e-NAM trade. It’s not about the quantity alone; quality builds buyer confidence,” said Mohammad Ashraf, a Valley-based fruit trader, stressing the importance of post-harvest standards.

Introduced nationally in 2016, e-NAM enables farmers to access a broader network of buyers beyond their local mandis through transparent online bidding, with payments credited directly to their bank accounts.

Officials said that the government provides financial support of up to ₹75 lakh per mandi to strengthen infrastructure, including electronic weighing systems, grading and packaging units, quality-testing labs and digital facilities.

Across India, 1,656 mandis have been integrated into the platform, benefiting more than 1.8 crore farmers and 2.72 lakh traders. The total trade on the platform has crossed 13 crore tonnes, which was valued at ₹4.82 lakh crore as of February 2026.

‘India well-prepared to meet 270 GW peak power demand’

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India is well-prepared to meet the projected peak power demand of 270 GW during this Summer season, Union Power Minister Manohar Lal said on Thursday. The statement assumes significance in view of the ongoing West Asia crisis, when the use of electric appliances like induction cookers, as well as electric vehicles, is likely to increase.

Addressing the Bharat Electricity Summit 2026, he said, “We always keep an eye on our peak demand. Our peak demand, that is, the maximum amount of power we need at any given time.”

INCREASING DEMAND

Two years ago, in 2024-25,

India had a peak demand of 250 GW. In 2025-26, the Power Ministry had set a higher target of 270 GW, but due to weather conditions, peak demand did not increase to the estimated levels, he added. “This time too, we’ve made preparations that if we need to supply up to 270 GW of power this May-June, then we are prepared. There’s no problem,” the Minister said.

About the power demand, Khattar stated that this is only going to increase in the future as the era of AI dawn, data centres are built and EVs are used. “As we progress in all these areas, we’ll need at least 30 GW for these tasks over the next five-six years. At that time, our target of 300 GW (peak power demand) will be reached on its own,” he pointed out.

Maharashtra govt to raise over ₹2,500 crore via bond sales for development works

Our Bureau
Pune

The Maharashtra government will raise over ₹2,500 crore through the sale of multiple government securities of varying maturities to fund development projects, the Finance Department said in an official statement.

The borrowing programme includes a fresh issuance of 10-year bonds worth ₹1,000 crore, with an option to raise an additional ₹500 crore. The auction for these securities will be conducted by the RBI at its Mumbai office on March 24, with the bids to be submitted through its e-Kuber system.

The 10-year bonds will commence from March 25, 2026, and mature on March

The auction for securities will be conducted by the RBI at its Mumbai office on March 24, with the bids to be submitted through its e-Kuber system

25, 2036. The coupon rate will be determined through the auction process, and interest will be paid semi-annually on September 25 and March 25.

The State will also sell previously raised long-term securities, including ₹1,000-crore worth of 26-year bonds (7.66 per cent Maharashtra government securities 2052) and ₹530 crore worth of 21-

year bonds (7.66 per cent Maharashtra government securities 2047). Both these issuances were raised on March 4, and carry a fixed coupon rate of 7.66 per cent per annum.

The 26-year bonds will mature on March 4, 2052, while the 21-year bonds will mature on March 4, 2047. Interest on these securities will be paid twice a year, on March 4 and September 4.

DEVELOPMENT WORKS

The government has stated that the proceeds from these borrowings will be utilised for financing developmental works across the State. Under the revised non-competitive bidding mechanism, 10 per cent of the notified amount of government securities will be reserved for

eligible individual and institutional investors. However, allocation to a single investor will be capped at 1 per cent of the total notified amount.

The Finance Department also clarified that investments made by banks in these government securities will qualify as Statutory Liquidity Ratio under the provisions of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949.

Additionally, the bonds will be eligible for trading in the secondary market, making them accessible for repurchase and resale.

Officials said the structured borrowing plan is aimed at ensuring steady financial resources for development activities while maintaining liquidity and investor participation in State government securities.

Bird flu confirmed in Alappuzha; culling operations from Friday

Press Trust of India
Alappuzha

Bird flu (H5N1) has been confirmed in Ward 7 of the Muhamma grama panchayat in Alappuzha district, prompting authorities to initiate containment measures in line with the Centre’s 2021 action plan, officials said on Thursday. Over 5,000 birds will be culled.

A decision to implement preventive and control measures was taken at an emergency meeting chaired by Collector Inbasekar Kalimuthu, a government release said.

The Animal Husbandry Department has deployed rapid response teams to carry out culling operations within a 1 km radius of the epicentre. “As many as 5,961 domestic

birds in the affected zone will be culled. The culling operations are scheduled to begin on the morning of March 21,” the statement said.

The district administration has issued guidelines for various departments to contain the spread of the disease. The public has been urged to remain vigilant, the release said.

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Amiti Sen
New Delhi

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Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Note: The DEA has stopped publishing actual ODI outflow after August 2025
Source: RBI, Department of Economic Affairs (DEA)

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

PRICE WAR

- Wegovy's weekly price ranges between ₹2,700 and ₹4,100
- Ozempic was priced between ₹8,800 and ₹11,175 for a four-week pack, at its launch in December 2025
- Eli Lilly's Mounjaro cost ₹14,000-27,000 per month (for different strengths) at launch



Reuters
Bengaluru



KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad



Dr. Anand Kulkarni is a senior research scientist at the Center for Data Science, Indian Institute of Technology Bombay. He has a Ph.D. from the University of California, Berkeley, and has worked at Google Research and Microsoft Research. He is currently working on machine learning, data science, and artificial intelligence.

CM
Y
K

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI
Parag Milk	201.74	193.86	198.00	199.70	192.00	623.38	32.70	142.10	15	193.85	Sesha Paper [2]	263.90	259.10	264.54	274.00	257.20	60.31	323.80	213.00	22	258.35	TPL PLAST [2]	64.32	61.09	63.10	63.35	60.51	74.45	95.50	58.01	17	60.98
PARAMOUNT [2]	35.05	34.23	34.00	35.00	34.00	67.60	32.30	18	34.35	Seshaaasi Tea	228.85	274.31	253.25	253.70	229.00	439.87	43.77	227.01			Trans&Rect	288.85	274.31	253.25	253.70	229.00	439.87	43.77	227.01			
Paras Inds	60.95	60.35	60.95	60.95	60.35	55.50	18.00	17	60.95	SG Mart Ltd	439.75	436.00	422.00	447.00	422.00	549.38	47.90	313.00			Transair Li	514.85	490.03	505.00	508.00	491.35	37.57	855.90	394.55			
Park Hotels	201.13	198.27	198.27	201.13	198.27	17.20	105.13			SGM&L	383.10	373.20	380.00	382.95	371.20	70.45	45.80	333.00			Transw.Shp	134.44	133.05	132.00	138.99	128.40	161.07	32.95	124.23			
Park MidWest	201.13	198.27	198.27	201.13	198.27	17.20	105.13			Sh Renu Sug [1]	24.06	23.81	23.27	24.67	23.55	57.21	35.84	22.86			TravelFood	1132.70	1102.20	1125.00	1135.00	1094.10	37.45	1445.00	100.50			
Passputi Agr	46.36	44.59	45.00	46.00	44.29	87.24	63.35	40.10		Shankara Bul	24.77	24.63	25.00	25.30	24.25	302.94	63.55	24.00			TREX&Aero	3640.90	3480.00	3600.00	3600.00	3472.00	68.24	6259.00	3428.90			
Pattali Inds	490.15	474.30	485.80	492.05	469.31	2011.00	272.05			Shadowfax	112.39	109.52	108.13	111.00	106.97	146.95	11.73	98.55			TRIDENT [1]	24.44	23.28	23.00	24.00	23.12	321.24	77.99	22.00			
Patel engg [1]	24.97	24.66	24.65	25.00	24.29	8122.24	45.59	23.33	6	24.68	Shaily Eng	2351.30	2294.20	2271.80	2387.60	2270.00	579.45	2799.90	1372.65			Trigen tech	45.10	47.66	49.00	50.43	47.00	67.71	101.33	47.77		
Patel Refrig	173.58	166.30	170.00	175.59	165.25	62.59	305.00	155.00		SHALBY	144.19	138.79	143.00	143.00	137.82	98.24	25.40	137.00	20		TRIVENI [1]	47.50	46.52	47.00	47.40	46.20	175.79	67.45	44.95			
Pattani Inds	427.40	404.80	404.20	406.60	403.50	199.90	138.00	68.10		SHALINI P&I	47.69	45.40	46.90	46.90	45.10	189.28	11.81	44.00			Truist Bio	388.05	396.38	385.00	400.00	381.00	220.76	549.00	310.20			
PayTM	153.78	156.39	157.00	157.59	156.25	65.29	305.00	155.00		Shankara Bld	109.90	110.04	108.90	114.00	106.95	129.98	31.10	38.50			TSF Invest	37.70	36.05	36.50	37.00	35.80	105.75	70.10	25.55			
PCCF&M	698.80	602.80	601.00	602.80	601.00	601.00	613.30	602.80		Shankar Lal	101.15	95.84	96.00	99.62	95.05	200.88	229.70	101.15			Tube Invst.	255.70	253.00	250.00	255.50	247.00	285.86	349.90	216.90			
PDS	275.40	258.25	272.90	275.25	256.40	123.28	46.00	256.40		Shankar Lal	47.22	45.04	45.30	47.99	45.30	116.66	91.00	39.15			Tvs Elec	40.44	38.04	40.00	40.75	37.60	38.05	740.85	29.45			
PENNAR IND [5]	143.61	139.53	140.15	144.47	138.50	67.43	279.80	133.50	19	339.40	SHARD MO [2]	62.25	78.90	81.05	81.05	78.54	31.97	125.00	62.00	14	78.80	Unichem I	32.25	31.65	31.50	32.20	31.50	43.58	72.95	30.25		
PETROCL	291.60	252.40	260.00	265.00	252.40	57.37	66.00	252.40		ShareInd Sec	82.79	122.51	125.98	127.12	123.12	61.57	21.10	122.13			Unichem-eSol	95.33	90.85	93.00	95.04	90.00	66.88	155.80	90.00			
Pfizer Ltd	881.00	4724.04	4784.00	4784.00	4784.00	7.13	5987.65	3742.90	11	4784.00	Shilcilind	62.62	60.17	62.00	62.00	62.00	42.72	107.70	58.20			Unichem-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10		
PG Electro [1]	536.85	504.50	515.85	526.55	502.90	365.88	108.00	471.15	15	504.30	SHILPA MED [1]	324.60	314.75	315.00	325.55	312.00	234.57	50.10	266.00	56	314.50	Unichem-L	32.25	31.65	31.50	32.20	31.50	43.58	72.95	30.25		
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		Shipping Cor	24.05	23.10	23.60	23.75	22.85	1993.46	280.35	143.05			Uniparts Ind	45.99	45.44	45.40	46.00	45.00	52.40	54.95	29.65			
Phoenix Mill [2]	162.71	157.50	158.00	160.00	156.20	37.94	196.50	140.03	193	157.95	Shippor Spt [5]	42.19	41.12	42.12	42.12	41.00	52.67	7.34	40.64			Univ.Ind	1.49	1.49	1.49	1.49	1.49	1.49	1.49	1.49		
PhysicWall	86.82	86.25	82.91	86.08	82.85	11141.96	18.59	77.72		Shivalki Ras	251.80	241.80	249.50	250.00	245.00	55.43	69.05	241.00			Ugar Sugar [1]	99.49	92.19	95.00	95.90	91.20	177.93	99.98	83.12			
PIC&P	162.71	157.50	158.00	160.00	156.20	37.94	196.50	140.03	193	157.95	Shivalki Ras	251.80	241.80	249.50	250.00	245.00	55.43	69.05	241.00			Ugar Sugar [1]	99.49	92.19	95.00	95.90	91.20	177.93	99.98	83.12		
PiccadillyAgr	54.62	54.65	54.00	55.00	53.50	144.06	80.55	51.00		SHOPPER ST [5]	300.00	289.15	299.00	299.70	288.00	22.88	58.58	267.00			Ugro Jhon	55.61	52.49	53.92	54.82	52.32	102.01	77.98	83.12			
Pidilite [1]	138.40	138.08	137.40	137.40	138.08	68.90	157.00	138.08	30	138.08	Shree Cement	2392.50	2333.00	2341.00	2364.00	2312.00	20.07	2508.20	2286.70			Unimol	32.25	31.65	31.50	32.20	31.50	43.58	72.95	30.25		
Piani Inc.	1786.10	4845.30	4705.00	4800.00	4656.70	31.42	5976.00	3691.00	60	4838.35	SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-eSol	95.33	90.85	93.00	95.04	90.00	66.88	155.80	90.00		
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
Piramal Fin	108.80	108.60	106.90	108.10	107.10	32.35	194.50	126.00		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
Piramal Pfr	143.12	135.72	140.00	141.18	135.14	313.06	24.50	134.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96			Unimol-L	123.80	123.80	121.10	123.80	121.10	19.33	123.80	121.10			
PIC&P	170.00	167.50	168.00	170.00	167.50	199.30	38.00	167.50		SHREE NAM TWH	14.13	48.27	47.40	50.80	46.00	47.30	73.36	45.96														